CLASS NOTES · TADABBUR SIRI 14

Surah *Al-Kauthar*

Thursday, 24 September 2026 | Surah ke-108 · 3 ayat — the shortest surah | Theme: **nikmat**

IN SHORT

- Al-Kauthar = abundant good, including the river in Jannah and the Prophet's ﷺ telaga.
- Nikmat calls for more ibadah: pray and sacrifice, sincerely, for your Lord.
- The one who hates the Prophet ﷺ and his sunnah is the one truly cut off.

1. Text & meaning

إِنَّا أَعْطَيْنَاكَ الْكَوْثَرَ ﴿١﴾ فَصَلِّ لِرَبِّكَ وَانْحَرْ ﴿٢﴾ إِنَّ شَانِئَكَ هُوَ الْأَبْتَرُ ﴿٣﴾

WORD BY WORD

1

إِنَّا	أَعْطَيْنَاكَ	الْكَوْثَرَ
sesungguhnya Kami	telah memberikan kepadamu	al-Kauthar — kebaikan yang melimpah

Sesungguhnya Kami telah memberikan kepadamu al-Kauthar (kebaikan yang banyak, melimpah ruah).

2

فَصَلِّ	لِرَبِّكَ	وَانْحَرْ
maka solatlah	kerana Tuhanmu	dan berkorbanlah

Maka solatlah kerana Tuhanmu, dan berkorbanlah.

3

إِنَّ	شَانِئَكَ	هُوَ	الْأَبْتَرُ
sesungguhnya	orang yang membencimu	dialah	yang terputus

Sesungguhnya orang yang membencimu, dialah yang terputus.

Inna, a'tainaka = *"**We** have given" — the plural of majesty. **Makkiyyah or Madaniyyah?** Makkiyyah is the more widely held view (the printed mushaf label, and the reports about Quraysh mocking the Prophet ﷺ). The strongest hadith on its revelation — Anas r.a. saw the Prophet ﷺ wake smiling in the masjid and recite it as just revealed (Muslim 400) — points to Madinah, and Ibn Kathir opens with "revealed in Madinah, and it's said Makkah". Both are recognised views.*

2. Ayat 1 — what is al-Kauthar?

Al-Kauthar comes from *kathrah* — **abundance**. Ibn 'Abbas: it's the abundant good Allah gave the Prophet ﷺ. When told "people say it's a river in Jannah", Sa'id bin Jubayr replied: that river is **part of** that good (Bukhari 4966). Al-Razi gathered 15 views on its meaning, al-Qurtubi 16 — including the

river, the telaga, prophethood, the Quran, Islam, a large ummah, raised mention, and syafaat. They're examples of one wide meaning, not contradictions.

From class — examples of this abundant good, not only for the Prophet ﷺ but for his ummah too:

- **His name raised** — mentioned constantly to this day: in the azan, tasyahhud, selawat (Asy-Syarh 94:4: "dan Kami tinggikan sebutanmu").
- **The river in Jannah** — on the night of Mi'raj he saw a river whose banks were domes of hollow pearl; Jibril said: "This is al-Kauthar your Lord gave you" (Bukhari 6581). Its banks are gold, it flows over pearls and rubies, its soil more fragrant than musk, its water sweeter than honey and whiter than snow (Tirmidhi 3361 · sahih).
- **The telaga (Hawd)** — where the ummah will come to drink on the Day of Judgement: a month's journey wide, water whiter than milk, more fragrant than musk, cups like the stars; whoever drinks from it will never thirst again (Bukhari 6579; Muslim 400).
- **The life of a da'i** — a picture of what a life of dakwah looks like. Tadabbur Al-Hujurat 49:13: are we doing it for Allah?

The telaga and syafaat are two separate honours: at the telaga the Prophet ﷺ waits for his ummah to drink; syafaat is the "praised station" (Al-Isra' 17:79).

THE QURAN'S BLESSING NEVER STOPS — AL-AN'AM 6:155

وَهَٰذَا كِتَابٌ أَنزَلْنَاهُ مُبَارَكٌ فَاتَّبِعُوهُ وَاتَّقُوا لَعَلَّكُمْ تُرْحَمُونَ

"Dan ini sebuah Kitab yang Kami turunkan, yang diberkati; maka ikutilah ia dan bertakwalah, supaya kamu dirahmati."

AL-AN'AM 6:155

The Quran's goodness keeps flowing: **read, understand, act, share**. We enter Jannah by Allah's rahmat — and through the Quran we earn that rahmat. "No one's deeds will enter him into Jannah." "Not even you, O Messenger of Allah?" "Not even me, unless Allah covers me with His grace and mercy." (Bukhari 5673)

3. Ayat 2 — pray for your Lord, and sacrifice

- *Fa salli li-rabbik* — pray **for your Lord**, sincerely.
- *Wanhar* — sacrifice; the word *nahr* is specifically the slaughter of camels (Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah and others). Red camels were the most prized wealth of the Arabs — "lebih baik bagimu daripada unta merah" (Bukhari 4210). Sacrifice from the best, not the leftovers.
- Ibn Kathir: just as We gave you abundant good, make your prayer and your sacrifice sincerely for your Lord alone — unlike the idolaters who bowed and slaughtered for others. Compare Al-An'am 6:162: "Sesungguhnya solatku, ibadahku, hidupku dan matiku hanyalah untuk Allah."

AL-MA'UN VS AL-KAUTHAR

AL-MA'UN (107)	AL-KAUTHAR (108)
Stingy — repulsing the orphan, not encouraging feeding the poor	"We have given you abundant good"
Heedless of their solat	"So pray"

Riak — to be seen	"For your Lord" — sincere
Holding back small kindnesses	"And sacrifice" — give

In class: Al-Ma'un = solat without ikhlas; Al-Kauthar = solat with ikhlas. This pairing of the two surahs is well known in the books of tafsir.

4. Ayat 3 — who's really cut off?

- *Syani'aka* — the one who hates you: the musyrikin of Makkah.
- *Al-abtar* — cut off from Allah's rahmat.
- The musyrikin said the Prophet ﷺ had no surviving son, so his name would die with him. In reality, his name is mentioned again and again to this day.

*Ibn Kathir reports this was said by al-'As bin Wa'il (and also names others); the reports don't contradict each other. The Prophet ﷺ **did** have sons — al-Qasim, 'Abdullah and Ibrahim — but all died young.*

> Ibn Kathir: the one who hates you **and what you brought** — guidance and truth — is the one truly cut off, forgotten and disgraced. Allah kept the Prophet's ﷺ name alive and made his syariat binding until the Last Day.

Can a believer be "cut off" too? From class: make our words match our deeds, or we risk it. Ibn Taymiyyah explains that anyone who hates something the Prophet ﷺ brought gets a **share** of being "cut off", in proportion to that hatred. At the telaga, some of the ummah will be turned away: "You don't know what they introduced after you" (Muslim 400). It's a warning about degrees — not a label for any individual.

5. Sunnah hasanah vs sunnah sayyi'ah

مَنْ سَنَّ فِي الْإِسْلَامِ سُنَّةً حَسَنَةً فَلَهُ أَجْرُهَا وَأَجْرُ مَنْ عَمِلَ بِهَا بَعْدَهُ مِنْ غَيْرِ أَنْ يَنْقُصَ مِنْ أُجُورِهِمْ شَيْءٌ، وَمَنْ سَنَّ فِي الْإِسْلَامِ سُنَّةً سَيِّئَةً كَانَ عَلَيْهِ وِزْرُهَا وَوِزْرُ مَنْ عَمِلَ بِهَا مِنْ بَعْدِهِ مِنْ غَيْرِ أَنْ يَنْقُصَ مِنْ أَوْزَارِهِمْ شَيْءٌ

"Sesiapa yang memulakan dalam Islam suatu amalan yang baik, baginya pahalanya dan pahala orang yang mengamalkannya selepasnya, tanpa dikurangkan sedikit pun pahala mereka. Dan sesiapa yang memulakan suatu amalan yang buruk, ke atasnya dosanya dan dosa orang yang mengamalkannya selepasnya, tanpa dikurangkan sedikit pun dosa mereka."

MUSLIM 1017 (JARIR BIN 'ABDULLAH) · SAHIH

The context: a very poor group from Mudar came to Madinah. The Prophet ﷺ urged people to give; one Ansari man brought a bag so heavy he could barely carry it — and others followed until there were two heaps of food and clothes. That's when he said this hadith. Similar: "Whoever calls to guidance gets the reward of those who follow it" (Muslim 2674).

*How wide is "sunnah hasanah"? An-Nawawi reads it as narrowing "every bid'ah is misguidance" to blameworthy innovations; asy-Syatibi reads it as starting or reviving a practice that **already has a basis** in the syariat — like the*

sedekah in the story. Both agree the hadith's own context is an established good deed.

6. Lessons from Al-Kauthar

#	LESSON	DALIL
1	**Believe** — Allah gives abundant good and Allah will protect. The youths of the cave were willing to leave everything and stay in a cave to protect their iman.	Al-Kahf 18:13–16 (full story 18:9–26)
2	Whoever **hates the Prophet ﷺ and his sunnah** is the one who's cut off.	108:3
3	The honoured aren't those with children or wealth, but those with **taqwa**.	Al-Hujurat 49:13
4	When given nikmat — **increase your ibadah**. The "so" (*fa*) in ayat 2 ties the command to the gift in ayat 1.	108:1–2; Bukhari 4837 ("shouldn't I be a grateful servant?")

Reflections

- **Legacy isn't measured by sons.** Quraysh measured a man's continuity by male heirs; Allah reversed that measure. What lasts is what we leave behind — knowledge, good deeds, sadaqah jariyah — not who carries our name.
- ***Wanhar*: give from the best.** Sacrifice was from the most prized wealth. When we give, is it from what we value, or from what's left over?
- **Be the one who starts the good.** In Muslim 1017, one person brought the first heavy bag and everyone followed. In our families, the first to start a good habit — giving, a wakaf, writing a wasiat — opens a path others will walk.
- **Nikmat first, then "so...".** Every increase in what we have is a cue to revisit our zakat, sedekah and ibadah — not just our lifestyle.

Personal notes from the 24/9/2026 class, compiled for revision and sharing. All ayat and hadith checked against quran.com, sunnah.com and dorar.net. Any mistakes are mine — please tegur. والله أعلم